

Chi (Faye) Zhang

Email: fayezc.cs@gmail.com | Homepage: fayezc.github.io

Ph.D. student
Department of Computer Science
The City University of New York, Graduate Center
365 Fifth Avenue, New York, NY 10016

EDUCATION

The City University of New York (CUNY), Graduate Center

Ph.D. student in Computer Science | GPA: 3.73/4.0

New York, NY

August 2024 – Present

Shandong University

B.E. in Software Engineering | GPA: 3.70/4.0

Jinan, CN

September 2019 – June 2023

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Cybersecurity, Usable Security, Generative AI Safety, Decentralized Privacy-Preserving ML, LLM-Assisted Education

HONORS AND AWARDS

- ACM CCS Individualized Cybersecurity Research Mentoring (iMentor) Workshop, Cohort 2023
- Outstanding Student Award, School of Software, Shandong University 2022
- Innovation and Entrepreneurship Scholarship, Shandong University 2020, 2021, 2022

PUBLICATIONS

- Zhang, C.**, Liu, Y., Chen, X., Ji, P. (2026). What Keeps Agent Skills from Being Reusable? Evidence from 138K SKILL.md Files. *First Workshop on Agent Skills (AgentSkills), ACM CAIS 2026*.
- Chen, X., **Zhang, C.**, Ji, P., Liu, Y. (2026). SkillsMetric: Mapping the Detection Boundary of Static Analysis for Malicious Agent Skills. *First Workshop on Agent Skills (AgentSkills), ACM CAIS 2026*.
- Cai, J., **Zhang, C.**, Ji, P. (2025). InsightFlow: A Generative AI Approach to Streamlining Knowledge and Learning Paths. *International Conference on Web-Based Learning (ICWL 2025)*.
- Gu, J., Du, Y., **Zhang, C.**, et al. (2023). Music Intervention in Human Life, Work, and Disease: A Survey. *International Journal of Crowd Science*, 7(3), 97–105.
- Du, Y., **Zhang, C.**, Wang, E., et al. (2021). Music Rhythm Matching Based on Dynamic Step Frequency. *Proceedings of the 5th International Conference on Crowd Science and Engineering (ICCSE '21)*, 113–118.

POSTERS

- Zhang, C.**, Ji, P., Zhang, Z. (2026). “We Have Never Been Attacked”: Unpacking the Illusion of Cybersecurity in Small Business. *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS 2026)*, Poster Session.
- Hanon, J., **Zhang, C.**, Ji, P. (2026). Privacy Tradeoffs in the Digital Era: Public Views on Data Use, Monitoring, and Accountability. *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS 2026)*, Poster Session.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Usable Security for Small Businesses

Oct 2024 – Present

Student Principal Investigator | Supervisor: Prof. Ping Ji | Full paper manuscript in preparation

New York, NY

- Independently designed and conducted a mixed-methods study ($N = 128$) on small business cybersecurity, including all participant interviews, survey deployment, qualitative analysis, and manuscript writing.
- Found that small business workers believe they are well-protected but often lack real security measures, a gap we define as the **security illusion**, driven by semantic narrowing, structural invisibility, and delegated trust.

Reusability and Security of Agent Skills

Mar 2026 – May 2026

Self-initiated | Supervisor: Prof. Ping Ji | Two workshop papers (ACM CAIS 2026)

New York, NY

- Led a large-scale empirical study of 138K SKILL.md files published after the agent skill format emerged, characterizing what prevents skills from being reused across projects (first author).
- Co-developed **SkillsMetric**, mapping where static analysis succeeds and fails at detecting malicious agent skills.

LLM Agents for Cyber Defense

Nov 2025 – Feb 2026

Supervisor: Prof. Ping Ji | Poster (AIX Summit 2026)

New York, NY

- Built and configured multi-agent experimental environments based on CybORG CAGE Challenges, conducted prompt ablation experiments and data analysis benchmarking GPT-4o and GPT-5.2 as autonomous Blue defenders.

AeDA Platform Development

Sep 2024 – Present

Supervisor: Prof. Ping Ji

New York, NY

- Full-stack developer for **AeDA** (Attainable eDucation for All), an AI-powered educational platform delivering personalized, goal-oriented learning paths. Designed and built the mobile app and web portal, and architected the data storage infrastructure on Google Cloud Platform (GCP).

Knowledge Tracing for Personalized Learning

Jul 2025 – Dec 2025

Supervisor: Prof. Ping Ji | Published (ICWL 2025)

New York, NY

- Contributed to dataset curation and manuscript writing for a graph-aware knowledge tracing framework integrating educator-curated knowledge graphs with Transformer-based models for personalized learning path generation within the **AeDA** platform.

Research Assistant, Shandong University

Nov 2020 – Jun 2023

Supervisors: Prof. Lizhen Cui, Prof. Yonghui Xu

Jinan, CN

- Conducted interdisciplinary research on computational music analysis for health applications, co-authoring a comprehensive survey (IJCS 2023) and developing a dynamic rhythm-matching algorithm (ICCSE '21).
- Contributed to the digitization of Traditional Chinese Medicine manuscripts through image preprocessing, optical character recognition, and structured data annotation.

TEACHING

- CSCI 49392 – Advanced Operating Systems, Hunter College, CUNY (Teaching Assistant; independently delivered lectures)

Spring 2026
 - CSCI 127 – Introduction to Computer Science, Hunter College, CUNY (Teaching Assistant)

Fall 2025

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer

- EMNLP 2026 Industry Track

2026
 - ICLR 2026 Workshop on Memory in Agentic AI (MemAgents)

2026
 - First Workshop on Agent Skills (AgentSkills), ACM CAIS 2026

2026
 - AAAI 2025 Undergraduate Consortium (UC)

2025

SKILLS

- Programming

Python, Java, C/C++, JavaScript, SQL, Bash, LaTeX.
 - Frameworks & Tools

LangChain, CybORG, Wireshark, Kali Linux, Git, Docker, GCP.
 - Security

Network Defense, LLM-based Cyber Defense, Threat Analysis.
 - AI & Productivity

Prompt Engineering, Advanced AI Coding Agents (Claude Code, Codex), Skills.
 - Research Methods

Mixed-Methods Study Design, Qualitative Analysis, AI-Augmented Workflow Design.